
Research and Teaching Interests

Peace and Conflict, Comparative Politics, Authoritarianism, Digitalization

Academic Positions

Since Sep. 2021 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Germany, Institutions and Political Inequality (IPI) unit (Macartan Humphreys)

Parental Leave: June-Dec. 2022 (1st child), Dec. 2024-July 2025 (2nd child)

2017-2021 **Research Associate**, University of St.Gallen, Institute of Political Science, Switzerland, Dissertation project and collaborative project: ‘Ownership of telecommunication companies and state control of the internet in authoritarian contexts’ (PI: Tina Freyburg)

2016 **Research Assistant**, German Centre for Integrative Biodiversity Research (iDiv), Leipzig, Germany, Collaborative project “Citizen Science” (PI: Aletta Bonn)

Visiting Positions:

2021 **Center for Digital Governance**, Hertie School, Berlin, Germany, (Host: Daniela Stockmann & Anita Gohdes)

2019-2020 **Oxford Internet Institute (OII)**, Oxford University, Oxford, United Kingdom, (Host: Joss Wright)

Career Breaks:

12.2024 - 08.2025 **Maternity Leave (2nd Child)**

06.2022 - 12.2022 **Maternity Leave (1st Child)**

Education

2017-2021 **PhD in Political Science (‘summa cum laude’)**, University of St.Gallen, International Affairs & Political Economy, Dissertation: ‘Authoritarian Survival in the Digital Age. Internet Access and Control in African Autocracies’, Jury: Tina Freyburg (University of St.Gallen) & Carl Henrik Knutsen (University of Oslo) & Joss Wright (University of Oxford)

Best Dissertation Award, International Affairs and Political Economy (DIA)

2013-2016 **MA in European Studies**, University of Leipzig

2014 visiting student at Ecole Normale Supérieure, Paris, France

2010-2013 **BA in Political Science, minor in Economics**, University of Freiburg

Additional Training (selection):

2019 **Technology and Regulation**, Oxford Internet Institute, Joss Wright

2019 **Regression Analysis for Spatial Data**, Global School in Empirical Research Methods, University of St.Gallen, Roland Füss & Zeno Adams

2017 **Time Series Analysis**, Global School in Empirical Research Methods, University of St.Gallen, Sara McLaughlin Mitchell

Edited Volumes/Special Issues

Garbe, Lisa and Seraphine F. Maerz. Special Issue: The rise of authoritarian informationalism: escalating surveillance, manipulation, and control. *Democratization*, 33(1):1–18, 2026.

Articles in peer-reviewed journals

Citation Indices (January 2026): Orcid: 0000-0001-7555-8007; Google scholar: 22 entries, 719 citations, h-index of 8; Web of Science 10 entries, 322 citations, h-index of 7

- [8] **Garbe, Lisa**, Seraphine F. Maerz, and Tina Freyburg. Authoritarian Collaboration and Repression in the Digital Age: Balancing Foreign Direct Investment and Control in Internet Infrastructure. *Democratization*, 33(1):85–108, 2026.
- [7] **Garbe, Lisa**, Nina McMurry, Alex Scacco, and Kelly Zhang. Who Wants to be Legible? Digitalization and Intergroup Inequality in Kenya. *Comparative Political Studies*, 58(9):1803–1853.
- [6] **Lisa Garbe**. Pulling through Elections by Pulling the Plug: Internet Disruptions and Electoral Violence in Uganda. *Journal of Peace Research*, 61(5):842–857, 2023.
- [5] Tina Freyburg, **Garbe, Lisa**, and Véronique Wavre. The Political Power of Internet Business: A Comprehensive Dataset of Telecommunications Ownership and Control (TOSCO). *The Review of International Organizations*, 18(3):573–600, 2023.
- [4] **Garbe, Lisa**, Lisa-Marie Selvik, and Pauline Lemaire. How African Countries Respond to Fake News and Hate Speech. *Information, Communication & Society*, 26(1):86–103, 2023.
- [3] **Garbe, Lisa**, Richard Rau, and Theo Toppe. Influence of Perceived threat of Covid-19 and HEXACO Personality Traits on Toilet Paper Stockpiling. *Plos one*, 15(6):e0234232, 2020.
- [2] Kathleen Hermans and **Garbe, Lisa**. Droughts, Livelihoods, and Human Migration in Northern Ethiopia. *Regional Environmental Change*, 19:1101–1111, 2019.
- [1] Tina Freyburg and **Garbe, Lisa**. Authoritarian Practices in the Digital Age—Blocking the Bottleneck: Internet Shutdowns and Ownership at Election Times in Sub-Saharan Africa. *International Journal of Communication*, 12:21, 2018.

Book Chapters

Garbe, Lisa, Daniel Mwesigwa, and Toussaint Nothias. From threat to advocacy: Facial recognition technologies in africa. In Toussaint Nothias and Lucy Bernholz, editors, *AI and Assembly: Coming Together and Apart in a Datafied World*, pages 84–123. Stanford University Press, Stanford, CA, 2025.

Susanne Hecker, **Garbe, Lisa**, and Aletta Bonn. The european citizen science landscape—a snapshot. In Susanne Hecker, Mike Haklay, Anna Bowser, Zbigniew Makuch, Jan Vogel, and Aletta Bonn, editors, *Citizen Science - Innovation in Open Science, Society and Policy*, pages 190–200. UCL Press, 2018. Open Access, <https://discovery.ucl.ac.uk/id/eprint/10066022/>.

Work in progress

Nora Chirikire, **Garbe, Lisa**, and Yuequan Guo. Repression and its Perception in Authoritarian Regimes. *Pre-analysis Plan available at <https://osf.io/cptxs>, Target Journal: The Journal of Politics (planned submission date: February 2026)*.

Garbe, Lisa, Elena Kromark, Tina Freyburg, and Joss Wright. Deterrence or Backlash? How Online Censorship Affects Offline Protest. *Conference Paper (presented at NEPS, ECPR, EPSA), Target Journal: British Journal of Political Science (planned submission date: Spring 2026)*.

Tina Freyburg, **Garbe, Lisa**, and Joss Wright. Delegating censorship: Internet service providers' engagement in internet shutdowns. *Conference Paper (presented at NEPS and ECPR), Target Journal: Nature Communication (planned submission date: Winter 2026)*.

Garbe, Lisa, Felix Garten, Yuequan Guo, Dion Stevers, Daniela Stockmann, and Yue Xie. Dividing or Uniting? Experimental Evidence on the Persuasive Power of Chinese State Narratives Among European Diaspora. *Data collection scheduled for March 2026*.

Eliska Drapalova, **Garbe, Lisa**, James Rosenberg, Alexandra Scacco, and Yasemin Soysal. What's in your e-wallet? Citizen perceptions of the EU Digital Identity Wallet. *Data collection scheduled for March 2026*.

Garbe, Lisa, Yuequan Guo, Macartan Humphreys, and Lennard Naumann. Political Connections. Measuring the Influence of Business on Political Decision-Making. *Data collection currently on-going*.

Policy Briefs and Other Publications

Garbe, Lisa. Internet shutdowns: here's how governments do it. *The Conversation*, 2023.

Nic Cheeseman and **Garbe, Lisa**. Digital democracy is still a long way off in Africa: it takes more than technology. *The Conversation*, 2020.

Garbe, Lisa. What we do (not) know about internet shutdowns in Africa. *Democracy in Africa*, 2020.

Tina Freyburg and **Garbe, Lisa**. Blocking the Bottleneck. Internet shutdowns at election times in Sub-Saharan Africa. *The Open Technology Fund*, 2018.

Arthur Gwagwa and **Garbe, Lisa**. Exporting Repression? China's AI push into Africa. *Council on Foreign Relations*, 2018.

Knowledge Transfer

2022 **OPTIMA Network Measurement Training**, *Internews*, Workshop for African Journalists

2021 **Animated Short Stories**

#FreeMyInternet, a graphic novel to present research findings about internet shutdowns in an accessible way Workshops at high schools using material from graphic novel, <https://freemyinternet.info/>, with Tina Freyburg and Véronique Wavre

2018 **Video Documentary ‘Citizens Offline’**

shortlisted for Best Documentary Film, Amakula International Film Festival, Kampala, Uganda & Fast Forward Science Award, Germany, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ccKLk-UKqhE&t=9s>, with Tina Freyburg, Noemie Guignard, and Véronique Wavre

Media Coverage (selected)

- 2024 **Aljazeera**, ‘*Stifling the internet: Authorities in Africa ‘deliberately stopping access’*’
- 2020 **CNN**, ‘*Why are we hoarding toilet paper? It may be your personality type’*’
- 2020 **One Zero**, ‘*The Great Indian Internet Shutdown Is the Troubling Future of Protest Control’*’
- 2018 **Deutsche Welle**, ‘*Internet censorship in Africa threatens democracy, economy’*’

Teaching Experience

- Spring 2024 **Digitalization, Development, and Democracy**, MA in Public Policy, Hertie School Berlin, self-designed elective seminar in English (24h)
- Fall 2020 **Strategies of Social Science Inquiry**, MA in International Affairs, University of St.Gallen, Tutorial in English (24h)
- Spring 2019 **Introduction to Quantitative Methods**, BA in International Affairs, University of St.Gallen, tutorial in English (12h)
- Fall 2017 & 2018 **Introduction to Comparative Politics**, BA in International Affairs, University of St.Gallen, tutorial in English and German (48h)

Supervision of B.A. & M.A. Theses

- since 2022 **Tonje Olsrud**, MA Thesis: ‘*Stay or Leave? How Internet Service Providers Navigate Internet Shutdown Requests in Conflict Settings*’, University of Oslo, main supervisor
- 2019 **Anja Bodenmann**, BA Thesis: ‘*Comparative Analysis of Strategies in Corporate Social Responsibility in the Aftermath of the Egyptian Internet Shutdown*’, University of St.Gallen, co-mentor
- 2018 **Alan Natale**, BA Thesis: ‘*Egypt’s Internet Shutdown During the Arab Spring: Explaining the Reasons for Vodafone’s Compliance*’, University of St.Gallen, co-mentor

Fellowships and Awards

- 2025 **Leibniz Mentoring Programme**, Programme for highly qualified female post-doctorate researchers on their path to obtaining a professorship, Competitive Selection Procedure, Leibniz Association
- 2022 **Best Disseration Award**, Doctoral programme in International Affairs, School of Economics and Political Science, University of St.Gallen, CHF 1.000
- 2019/2020 **Doc.Mobility grant**, Research stay at the Oxford Internet Institute as visiting PhD researcher for 12 months, Swiss National Science Foundation, CHF 80.000
- 2017 **Bucerius fellowship**, field research in Uganda October/November 2018, German Zeit Foundation, EUR 3.000
- 2016 **Promos scholarship**, Field research in Ethiopia February-April 2016, German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD), EUR 1.500

Research Grants

- Co-PI **WZB, Seed Funding**, ‘What’s in your e-wallet? Citizen perceptions of the EU Digital Identity Wallet’, CO-PI with Eliska Drapalova (WZB), James Rosenberg (WZB), Alex Scacco (WZB), and Yasemin Soysal (WZB), Funding: ca. EUR 20’000)
- Co-PI **European Commission, Horizon Europe**, ‘The Long Arm of Authoritarian States. Suppressing Independent Voices Within and Beyond Their Borders (ARM)’, PI: Lovise Aalen (CMI Bergen), Co-PI for Work Package 6 on ‘Identifying Effects and Developing Toolkits’ with Gunhild Hoogensen (University of Tromsø), Funding allocated to WZB: EUR 239,425.00, Overall Funding: ca. EUR 3,000,000)
- Co-Applicant **Swiss National Science Foundation, Agora Science Communication**, ‘#Free-MyInternet. A Graphic Journey from Infrastructure to Shutdowns’, PI: Tina Freyburg (University of St.Gallen), Funding: CHF 47’727
- Co-Applicant **University of St.Gallen, Basic Research Fund**, ‘Ownership of Telecommunication Companies and State Control of the Internet in Authoritarian Contexts’, PI: Tina Freyburg (University of St.Gallen), Funding: CHF 98’697
- Co-Applicant **ISA Venture Research Grant**, ‘The Internet as a Research Tool: Bridging Politics and Technology in the Study of Internet Shutdowns’, PI: Tina Freyburg (University of St.Gallen), Funding: CHF 14’326

Academic Service

- Ongoing **Reviewing**, American Journal of Political Science, Journal of Peace Research, Democratization, Journal of Information Technology and Politics, International Political Science Review, International Journal of Communication, Journal of Modern African Studies, Government & Opposition, The International Journal of Press/Politics
- Ongoing **Ombudsperson**, WZB Berlin Social Science Center
- 2023, 2024 **WZB IPI Brown Bag Seminar Series**, Organizing Committee
- 2023, 2024 **WZB IPI**, Selection Committee for Post- and predoctoral fellowships
- 2019 **Peer Mentoring**, HSG student team QWERTY, participation in the annual Cyber Challenge in Geneva

Invited Talks

- Oct. 2025 ‘**Authoritarianism in the Digital Age: Surveillance, Manipulation, and Control**’, University of Antwerp, Belgium
- Nov. 2023 ‘**Deterrence or Backlash? How Online Censorship Affects Offline Protest**’, Hertie School Berlin, Germany
- Nov. 2021 ‘**Delegating Censorship: Internet Service Providers’ Engagement in Internet Censorship in Africa**’, University of Bergen, Norway
- Nov. 2021 ‘**Uses and Abuses of Social Media**’, Chr. Michelsen Institute (CMI), Bergen, Norway
- Feb. 2020 ‘**Internet Infrastructure and Control**’, Brownbag Lunch Series, Oxford Internet Institute, UK

Organization of Workshops & Panels

- 2023, 2024, 2026 ‘**MoPED-IGR**’, Berlin Meeting on the Political Economy of Development (MoPED) joint with Intergroup Relations Working Group (IGR), Workshop at WZB, with Yuequan Guo, Alex Scacco, and Georgiy Syunyaev

- Sep. 2023 **‘Digital Authoritarianism’**, *Section*, ECPR General Conference, with Seraphine Maerz
- Jun. 2019 **‘Business and Human Rights in Africa and South-Asia: Network Shutdowns and Data Disclosure Requests under Conflicting Legal Frameworks’**, *Panel*, RightsCon, Tunis, with Isabel Ebert
- Mar. 2019 **‘The Internet as a Research Tool: Bridging Politics and Technology in the Study of Internet Shutdowns’**, *Research Workshop*, ISA Annual Convention, Toronto, with Tina Freyburg, Véronique Wavre, and Ron Deibert
- Sep. 2018 **‘Ownership Matters! The Political Effects of Ownership Patterns across Key Infrastructures’**, *Panel*, DVPW Annual Conference, Frankfurt, together with Tina Freyburg
- Mar. 2018 **‘Internet Diffusion and its Political Effects in Authoritarian Contexts’**, *Panel*, Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, Chicago, together with Tina Freyburg
- Mar. 2017 **‘Telecommunication Politics in Authoritarian Contexts’**, *Workshop*, University of St.Gallen, together with Tina Freyburg and Véronique Wavre

Conference Presentation

- 2024 European Political Science Association (EPSA) Annual Conference
- 2023 European Consortium of Political Research (ECPR) General Conference
- 2023 Tinbergen Conference, Network of European Peace Scientists (NEPS)
- 2019,2021,2022 International Studies Association (ISA) Annual Convention
- 2021 European Political Science Association (EPSA) Annual Conference
- 2018, 2020 Deutsche Vereinigung für Politikwissenschaft (DVPW) General Conference
- 2019 American Association of Geographers (AAG) Annual Convention
- 2018 Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Convention
- 2018, 2021 Swiss Political Science Association (SPSA) Annual Conference
- 2019 GIGANET Conference

Field Research Experience

- 2024 **Kenya**, *In-depth interviews with survey participants about the support for eID*, 2 weeks
- 2018 **Uganda**, *Interviews with representatives from telecom companies, civil society, academia*, 6 weeks
- 2016 **Ethiopia**, *Survey and focus groups with farmers in Northern Ethiopia about the impact of droughts in livelihoods*, 2 months

International Collaborators

Lovise Aalen (University of Bergen, Norway), Nic Cheeseman (University of Birmingham, UK), Tina Freyburg (University of St.Gallen, Switzerland), Felix Garten (Hertie School, Germany), Yuequan Guo (WZB, Germany), Yuequan Guo (WZB, Germany), Macartan Humphreys (WZB, Germany), Elena Kromark (Stockholm University, Sweden), Pauline Lemaire (CMI, Norway), Seraphine Maerz (University of Melbourne, Australia), Nina McMurry (Vanderbilt University, US), Daniel Mwesigwa (Cornell University, US), Toussaint Nothias (New York University, US), Alex Scacco (WZB, Germany), Lisa-Marie Selvik (NORCE, Norway), Daniela Stockmann (Hertie School, Germany), Joss Wright (Oxford University, UK), Kelly Zhang (MIT, US)

Skills

Languages German (native), English, French, Spanish (fluent)
Computing L^AT_EX, R, GitHub

Academic Referees

Tina Freyburg, *Professor at the School of Economics and Political Science*,
University of St.Gallen, [tina.freyburg\[at\]unisg.ch](mailto:tina.freyburg@unisg.ch)

Carl Henrik Knutsen, *Professor in Political Science*, University of Oslo, contact:
[c.h.knutsen\[at\]stv.uio.no](mailto:c.h.knutsen@stv.uio.no)

Macartan Humphreys, *Director of Institutions and Inequality Unit*, WZB Berlin
Social Science Center, contact: [macartan.humphreys\[at\]wzb.eu](mailto:macartan.humphreys@wzb.eu)

Alex Scacco, *Deputy Director of Institutions and Inequality Unit*, WZB Berlin
Social Science Center, contact: [alex.scacco\[at\]wzb.eu](mailto:alex.scacco@wzb.eu)

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